

ZANZIBAR 7-DAY ISLAND ITINERARY

Tropical Adventure, Marine Sightseeing & Sunset Experience • December Edition

DURATION & DATES
7 Days / Dec 15–21

TRAVELER FOCUS
Nature & Water Sports

DIET PREFERENCE
Strict Veg / Indian Food

PACING & VIBE
Uncrowded & Scenic

DAILY ITINERARY & TIMETABLE

Day 1: Arrival & Historic Shoreline Sunset

STONE TOWN COAST

13:30 Arrive at Abeid Amani Karume Intl Airport; private transfer to oceanfront lodge.
15:30 Quiet walk along Shangani waterfront; capture coastal dhow boats (avoiding crowds).
17:45 **Sunset Viewing:** Golden hour photography from rooftop seaside terrace.

Meals (Strict Veg): Lunch: Hotel Veg Lounge | **Dinner: Spice Route Restaurant** (Authentic North/South Indian Curry & Jain options available).

Day 2: Nakupenda Sandbank & Coral Reef Snorkel

MUST-VISIT SPOT

08:00 Private boat departure from Stone Town beach to avoid tour groups.
09:00 Pristine white sandbank relaxing, landscape photography & crystal water swimming.
11:30 Guided snorkeling session around surrounding coral gardens with vibrant marine life.
16:00 Return to mainland; leisurely evening relaxing at hotel gardens.

Meals (Strict Veg): Lunch: Fresh Tropical Fruit & Veggie Picnic on Sandbank | **Dinner: Silk Route Zanzibar** (Indian Thalís & Tandoori Roti).

Day 3: Mnemba Atoll Marine Reserve Snorkeling

UNDERWATER ADVENTURE

06:30 Early transfer north to Muyuni Beach for quiet early-morning boat launch.
08:30 **Marine Sightseeing:** Snorkel Mnemba Coral Reef; spot sea turtles & wild dolphins.
12:30 Transfer to quiet Nungwi northern coast for check-in at beachfront resort.
17:30 **Sunset Photography:** Panoramic shots of iconic northern headland cliffs.

Meals (Strict Veg): Lunch: Cafe Cocoloba (Veg Wraps & Smoothies) | **Dinner: Masala Indian Restaurant Nungwi** (Paneer Butter Masala & Dal Tadka).

Day 4: Deep-Sea Kayaking & Kendwa Sunset

WATER SPORTS

06:00 **Sunrise Viewing:** Dawn photo walk along calm, empty shoreline.
09:30 Guided sea kayaking along northern bay reefs & stand-up paddleboarding.
14:00 Afternoon leisure; shaded ocean-view photography and relaxing.
17:30 Walk to quiet Kendwa stretches for world-famous, unobstructed sunset views.

Meals (Strict Veg): Lunch: Badolina Secret Garden (Pure Veg & Falafel) | **Dinner: Fisherman's Seafood & Veg Grill** (Dedicated Veg/Indian Menu).

Day 5: Jozani Forest & Chwaka Bay Mangroves

ECOLOGY & ADVENTURE

07:30 Private drive south to Jozani Chwaka Bay National Park.
08:30 Nature photography walk through Mahogany forest; view rare Red Colobus Monkeys.
11:00 Guided boardwalk adventure through serene mangrove swamp ecosystem.
15:30 Transfer to peaceful East Coast (Paje/Michamvi); check-in at quiet beach resort.

Meals (Strict Veg): Lunch: Eco-Jungle Cafe (Pure Veg Curries) | **Dinner: Coconut Spices Indian Restaurant** (South Indian Dosa & Biryani).

Day 6: Paje Lagoon Water Sports & Kae Sunset

ACTIVE LAGOON

05:45 **Sunrise Magic:** Sunrise over Indian Ocean lagoon (prime photo opp).
09:00 Beginner Kitesurfing taster or Hydrofoil Lagoon excursion in shallow turquoise waters.
14:30 Tide-pooling marine discovery walk during low tide along pristine sand flats.
17:15 Head to Kae Funk Bay for spectacular west-facing east-coast sunset.

Meals (Strict Veg): Lunch: Delight Zanzibar (Veg/Vegan Bowls) | **Dinner: Sea & Spice Restaurant** (Veg Korma, Naan & Indian Delights).

Day 7: Sunrise Lagoon & Departure

FAREWELL

06:00 Final tranquil sunrise meditation and beach photography along Paje shore.
09:30 Check-out; scenic private drive across island to Stone Town souvenir craft cooperative.
12:30 Transfer to Abeid Amani Karume Intl Airport for departure flight home.

Meals (Strict Veg): Lunch: Chowpatty Sweets & Snacks (100% Pure Veg Indian Street Food & Meals near airport).

ESTIMATED BUDGET (PER PERSON)

CATEGORY	DETAILS	USD (\$)
Lodging	6 Nights Mid-Range Beach Resorts	\$600
Meals	7 Days Indian/Veg Restaurants	\$210
Transport	Private Transfers & Boat Charters	\$250
Activities	Mnemba, Sandbank, Jozani, Kayak	\$220
Estimated Total		\$1,280

**Excludes international flights. Tipping (~10%) and marine park entry fees included in activity estimate.*

BAD-WEATHER BACKUP OPTIONS

- Zanzibar Spice Farm Cooking Class:** Covered organic farm tour & hands-on pure vegetarian Indian/Swahili spice cooking workshop.
- Old Fort & Culture Center:** Covered courtyards in Stone Town offering local art, henna workshops & indoor photography.
- Seaweed Center (Paje):** Indoor artisan processing tour learning how local women harvest coastal ocean plants into organic products.
- Oceanfront Spa & Yoga:** Covered wellness & meditation sessions overlooking high-tide ocean views.

PRACTICAL TRAVEL NOTES

- Weather in Dec:** Warm & sunny (28–32°C). Short intermittent afternoon rains possible; morning water tours are best.
- Vegetarian Catering:** Confirm "Strict Veg / No Meat / No Fish Sauce" when ordering. All recommended spots cater well to Indian palates.
- Marine Equipment:** Bring personal rashguards, reef-safe sunscreen, and waterproof camera housing for marine photos.
- Local Etiquette:** Respect local customs by covering shoulders/knees when traveling through villages outside resorts.
- Transport Tip:** Pre-book private taxis for smooth transfers and avoiding crowded public buses (Dala-dalas).

KEY PHOTO OPPORTUNITIES

- Nakupenda sandbank turquoise water contrast
- Mnemba coral reef underwater marine life
- Red Colobus monkeys in Jozani canopy light
- Kendwa & Kae Funk unhindered ocean sunsets
- Paje sunrise with low-tide wooden dhows